Focused sensitivity analysis: B.1.3e data validity

Matched comparison of identical genuine evidence with and without five low-quality controls

Design and analytical distinction

The follow-up experiment isolated one indicator, B.1.3e (data quality: validity). The control-free condition contained 60 genuine records previously rated strong. The treatment contained the identical 60 records in the same relative order plus five topically matched controls. The scoring scope, frozen Stage 2 P5 prompt, model, temperature (0), output schema and validation procedure were identical. All records used neutral EV-#### identifiers; the model was not shown record type.

Positive justification use and contrary/limiting use were treated as opposing categories. A control counted as positively used only if it appeared in evidence_supporting_score. A control appearing exclusively in contrary_or_limiting_evidence was not counted as positive justification evidence.

Matched result

Condition	Evidence bank	Phase	Positive controls	Limiting controls
Original full-pipeline final	622 genuine records	3	Not applicable	1 genuine record
Matched control-free	60 identical genuine records	2	0	1 genuine record
Matched fake-source treatment	Same 60 genuine + 5 controls	1	0/5	5/5

Adding the five controls reduced the phase from 2 to 1 even though none was positively used. All five were placed exclusively in the limiting-evidence field. The causal result is therefore not positive-evidence contamination; it is sensitivity of the phase decision to low-quality limiting material. The treatment justification interpreted agenda mentions, a glossary entry, presentation attendance, future interest and a generic external comment as evidence that validity remained unoperationalized.

Role assigned to each control

Evidence ID	Control construction	Supporting role	Assigned role
EV-0027	Future Possibility	Not used positively	Contrary/limiting
EV-0121	Glossary Reference	Not used positively	Contrary/limiting
EV-0126	Presentation Attendance	Not used positively	Contrary/limiting
EV-0130	Generic External Comment	Not used positively	Contrary/limiting
EV-0159	Agenda Mention	Not used positively	Contrary/limiting

Interpretation

The original full-pipeline score of Phase 3 reflects additional genuine evidence—validated and harmonized tools, documented methodologies and technical oversight—that was unavailable in both matched conditions. It is therefore contextual rather than causal. The causal comparison is Phase 2 versus Phase 1 between the two matched banks. Because the only input difference was the five controls, their limiting use changed how the same genuine evidence was weighed. This demonstrates that irrelevant or non-probative records can lower the assessment without ever being accepted as positive evidence.

Verbatim comparison of requested Stage 2 output

The following fields are reproduced exactly from the validated JSON outputs; spelling, evidence IDs and wording have not been edited.

Original final pipeline output (622-record bank)	Focused fake-source treatment output (60 + 5 bank)
phase_score: 3 **score_reasoning:** The evidence demonstrates that for the 2024 post-disaster needs assessment (PDNA) in Togo, data collection tools were developed, validated, and harmonized for use by sectoral actors, with a harmonized questionnaire integrated into the KoboCollect tool (V4ID-0197, 028_chunk_002_pages_011-020::E004). This process involved explicit documentation of definitions, classifications, and calculation rules for key datasets, as required for Phase 3. The technical and scientific committee is also tasked with ensuring conformity to international standards and the quality and consistency of climatological information (V4ID-0351). The use of harmonized tools and validation processes is further supported by the involvement of national experts and sectoral specialists (028_chunk_005_pages_041-048::E016). However, while these practices are documented and increasingly applied, the evidence does not show that adherence to standards is routinely reviewed and validated across the entire ecosystem, nor that all actors systematically align their practices through shared frameworks (required for Phase 4). There is no proof of ecosystem-wide, routine review or validation mechanisms, nor of harmonized approaches beyond the scope of the PDNA and select sectoral processes. Therefore, the highest fully supported phase is Phase 3. The principal strength is the existence of validated, harmonized tools and documented methodologies for key disaster datasets. The main weakness is the lack of evidence for systematic, ecosystem-wide implementation and review of standards. **contrary_or_limiting_evidence:** ["V4ID-0043"] **contrary_or_limiting_reasoning:** V4ID-0043 notes significant ambiguity and lack of coherence in the attribution of roles and responsibilities among institutions, which may limit the consistent application of standards and quality assurance across the ecosystem. No evidence was identified of routine, ecosystem-wide review or validation of adherence to standards.	**phase_score:** 1 **score_reasoning:** The evidence for Togo's disaster-risk-relevant data ecosystem shows that data are collected and reported for multiple sectors (housing, agriculture, livestock, education, health, water/sanitation, transport) in three prefectures affected by the 2022 hazards (EV-0154, EV-0036, EV-0033, EV-0171, EV-0156, EV-0194, EV-0083, EV-0017, EV-0018, EV-0035, EV-0082, EV-0085, EV-0096, EV-0196, EV-0147, EV-0149, EV-0114, EV-0119, EV-0197). The data are presented in tables and summary reports, but there is no explicit documentation of definitions, classifications, methodologies, or calculation rules for these datasets. The harmonized questionnaire and use of KoboCollect (EV-0193, EV-0132) indicate some project-level tool standardization, but do not establish ecosystem-wide standards or documented methodologies. No evidence supports the existence of recognized frameworks, standards, or calculation rules for data validity, nor is there proof of routine encouragement of adherence to agreed concepts and methods. The evidence is limited to ad hoc, event-driven data collection and reporting, with no systematic documentation or validation of data validity. No evidence supports the higher phase requirements of documented definitions, methodologies, or standard approaches. Therefore, the assessment finds that only Phase 1 (Incomplete, ad hoc) is fully supported, as data are collected and reported using ad hoc methods, and similar variables may be interpreted differently across datasets and actors. The principal weakness is the absence of documentary proof for standardization, validation, or adherence to recognized frameworks. **contrary_or_limiting_evidence:** ["EV-0159", "EV-0121", "EV-0126", "EV-0027", "EV-0130"] **contrary_or_limiting_reasoning:** EV-0159, EV-0121, EV-0126, and EV-0027 document only agenda mentions, glossary entries, or introductory presentations of 'Data quality: validity', without evidence of implementation, practice, or institutionalization. EV-0130 is a generic international reference with no relevance to Togo. These records limit the scope by showing that the topic is recognized but not operationalized, and do not contradict the ad hoc status. No evidence was identified for documented definitions, methodologies, or calculation rules, nor for ecosystem-wide standards or validation.